

Vietnam traffic — what to know

What a tourist on a bike should know.



GOOD TO KNOW

- 1 Always carry documents.** The Blue Card (cà vẹt) showing 50cc and a matching frame number — this is the main thing.
- 2 Helmet is a must.** Rider and passenger.
- 3 Zero alcohol.** Heavy fines. Checks aren't daily — they're random: set up for 3–5 days, then gone.
- 4 Bigger vehicle goes first.** You're on a bike, so let cars and buses pass. Don't cut across — merge gently.
- 5 Signal turns with your hand.** Point right or left before turning — it's the norm here and people get it.
- 6 Honking is normal.** A short beep = "I'm here", it's polite.
- 7 Slow at junctions & turns.** Brake and look around: a car or person can appear suddenly. Never take them fast.
- 8 Slower at night.** Many bikes ride without lights; keep your headlight on.
- 9 Rain — brake early.** Road paint and manholes are slippery.
- 10 Park smart.** Don't leave the bike in crowded spots. Use a wheel lock or a guarded lot — bikes get stolen.